

DAY 11

Minutes of Meeting (MoM) & Meeting Management

Learning Objectives:

- Understand what a MoM is and why it is legally and operationally critical
- Learn the structure of a professional MoM document
- Understand how to facilitate meetings effectively as a PM
- Learn the difference between action items, decisions, and discussion points in a MoM
- **YouTube Search Terms:**
 - "How to write minutes of meeting"
 - "Meeting management for project managers"
 - "MoM template explained"
 - "How to run effective meetings"
- **Recommended Channels:**
 - [ProjectManager.com](https://www.projectmanager.com)
 - PM Majik
 - Google Project Management Certificate

Tasks:

- Study the **structure of a MoM** — Meeting Title, Date, Time, Location, Attendees, Agenda, Discussion Summary, Decisions Made, Action Items with owner and due date, Next Meeting Date — understand why every section exists
- Understand the **difference between three things** that happen in every meeting — **Discussions** (what was talked about), **Decisions** (what was agreed), and **Action Items** (who will do what by when) — learn why confusing these three is a PM mistake
- Learn **meeting facilitation** — how to keep meetings on agenda, how to handle a participant who dominates, how to ensure quiet participants are heard, and how to close a meeting with clear next steps
- Write **MoMs for three different meeting types** — a project kickoff meeting, a weekly status update, and an escalation meeting with a client — each should reflect a real scenario with realistic discussion points, 3 decisions, and 4 action items

Deliverable

- Three MoM documents: Kickoff, Weekly Status, and Escalation
- Short note: what happens to a project when MoMs are not written or not shared promptly

→ What is a MoM?

Minutes of Meeting (MoM) is an official record of what happened during a meeting. It captures:

- What was discussed
- What decisions were made
- What actions need to be completed
- Who is responsible
- By when the work must be done

Why is MoM Important?

Operational Importance

- Creates accountability
- Prevents misunderstandings
- Tracks progress
- Serves as a project history

Legal Importance

- Acts as documented evidence of agreements
- Protects organizations during disputes
- Shows approvals and commitments

→ Structure of a Professional MoM

Section	Purpose
Meeting Title	Identifies the meeting
Date & Time	Records when it occurred
Location / Platform	Indicates where it happened
Attendees	Shows who participated
Agenda	Lists topics to be discussed
Discussion Summary	Records key conversations
Decisions Made	Captures agreed outcomes
Action Items	Assigns tasks and deadlines
Next Meeting Date	Confirms future follow-up

→ Discussions vs Decisions vs Action Items

Type	Meaning	Example
Discussion	What people talked about	Team discussed delay in API development
Decision	What was agreed	Launch date moved to August 15
Action Item	Who will do what by when	Rahul to complete API integration by July 30

Common PM Mistake

Many new PMs mix discussions with decisions.

Wrong:

The team discussed testing.

Correct:

Discussion: Testing requires additional resources.

Decision: Add one QA engineer.

Action Item: Priya to onboard QA engineer by July 20.

→ Meeting Facilitation Practices

1. Keep Meetings on Agenda

- Share agenda before meeting
- Allocate time per topic
- Redirect off-topic discussions

Example:

"Let's park that topic and discuss it after today's agenda."

2. Handle Dominating Participants

If one person speaks too much:

"Thank you, Raj. Let's hear perspectives from others as well."

3. Encourage Quiet Participants

Ask direct but friendly questions:

"Anjali, you've worked closely on this feature. What's your view?"

4. Close with Clear Next Steps

Before ending:

- Summarize decisions
- Confirm action items
- Confirm deadlines
- Confirm next meeting

Example:

"We have agreed on the revised timeline. Four action items have been assigned and we'll review progress next Monday."

MoM 1: Project Kickoff Meeting

Meeting Title : Project Kickoff - Expense Tracker Application

Date & Time : 22 June 2026, 10:00 AM

Location : Google Meet

Attendees

- Project Manager
- Product Owner
- Development Lead
- QA Lead
- UI/UX Designer

Agenda

- Project overview
- Scope discussion
- Timeline planning

Discussion Summary

- Project goal is to develop a web-based expense tracker.
- Core features include registration, login, expense management, and reporting.
- Team discussed sprint duration and release milestones.
- Resource allocation was reviewed.

Decisions Made

1. Project will follow Scrum methodology.
2. Sprint duration will be 2 weeks.
3. MVP release planned for 15 August 2026.

Action Items

Action Item	Owner	Due Date
Create product backlog	Product Owner	25 June 2026
Prepare wireframes	UI/UX Designer	28 June 2026
Setup Jira project	Project Manager	24 June 2026
Configure development environment	Development Lead	26 June 2026

Next Meeting: 29 June 2026

MoM 2: Weekly Status Meeting

Meeting Title : Weekly Project Status Review

Date & Time : 29 June 2026, 11:00 AM

Location : Google Meet

Attendees

- Project Manager
- Development Team
- QA Team
- Product Owner

Agenda

- Sprint progress review
- Risks and blockers
- Upcoming tasks

Discussion Summary

- User registration module completed.
- Login module is under development.
- API integration is behind schedule.
- QA team requested early access to builds.

Decisions Made

1. API work receives highest priority this week.
2. Daily progress check-ins added until blocker is resolved.
3. QA team will receive builds every Friday.

Action Items

Action Item	Owner	Due Date
Complete login functionality	Dev Lead	3 July 2026
Resolve API blocker	Backend Developer	2 July 2026
Prepare test cases	QA Lead	4 July 2026
Update sprint dashboard	Project Manager	30 June 2026

Next Meeting: 6 July 2026

MoM 3: Client Escalation Meeting

Meeting Title: Client Escalation Meeting - Delivery Delay

Date & Time : 10 July 2026, 3:00 PM

Location : Google Meet

Attendees

- Client Representative
- Project Manager
- Delivery Manager
- Technical Lead

Agenda

- Review delivery delay
- Discuss impact
- Define recovery plan

Discussion Summary

- Client expressed concern regarding missed milestone.
- Delay caused by third-party API dependency.
- Team presented revised schedule.
- Risk mitigation options were discussed.

Decisions Made

1. New delivery date approved.
2. Additional developer assigned to accelerate work.
3. Client status updates will be sent twice per week.

Action Items

Action Item	Owner	Due Date
Share revised project plan	Project Manager	11 July 2026
Assign additional developer	Delivery Manager	11 July 2026
Complete API integration	Technical Lead	17 July 2026
Send client progress report	Project Manager	Every Tuesday & Friday

Next Meeting : 17 July 2026

Short Note: What Happens When MoMs Are Not Written or Shared Promptly?

When MoMs are not created or distributed on time, teams often forget important decisions, responsibilities become unclear, and deadlines are missed. Different stakeholders may have different interpretations of what was agreed during the meeting, leading to confusion and rework. Project risks may go unnoticed, accountability decreases, and disputes become difficult to resolve because there is no documented evidence of discussions or approvals. As a result, project delays, communication gaps, stakeholder dissatisfaction, and increased project costs become more likely. For this reason, a Project Manager should ideally share the MoM within 24 hours after every meeting.